

Appendix E: Course Enrolment and Study Planning FAQs

1. How many courses should I take each module?

Students are generally recommended to take around two courses per module, subject to curriculum requirements, course availability and their individual study plan. This study pace may allow students to complete all programme requirements within one academic year if you wish to do so. However, as the programme has a two-year normative study period, students are encouraged to consider their overall study plan, including participation in internships, career development activities, enrichment opportunities, Study Modules at HKU Global Centres and an Interdisciplinary Track.

Course load is one of the factors considered when assessing students for merit-based scholarships. Students are required to complete at least four courses during Modules 1-3 to be eligible for scholarship consideration, regardless of whether course exemptions have been granted, where applicable. Further details regarding the merit-based scholarship selection criteria will be shared on the [website](#).

2. When and how do I add or drop courses?

An add-drop period is available prior to each module, usually commencing one week before the start of the module and continuing through the first week of teaching, in addition to the Master Round course enrolment period. Students may add or drop courses through the [HKU Business School Course Enrolment System \(CES\)](#) during the designated period. Please note that no add/drop requests will be entertained after the respective deadlines.

Students who successfully enrol in a course during the add-drop period will be able to access the corresponding Moodle page within two to three working days after successful enrolment. If you are unable to access the Moodle page for a course in which you are enrolled beyond this timeframe, please contact the Programme Office for assistance.

For Study Modules at Global Centres and project-based capstone courses, please follow the specific timelines and instructions announced separately by the respective project teams.

3. Can I complete the programme and graduate within one academic year?

Yes. Although the programme has a two-year normative study period, students who wish to complete all programme requirements within one academic year may do so by following an appropriate study plan and fulfilling all graduation requirements.

Students who complete all programme requirements during their first year of study are required to complete the relevant graduation procedures within that academic year and indicate their preferred Congregation option through the [HKU Business School Course Enrolment System \(CES\)](#). For example, if a student completes all programme requirements during the 2026-27 academic year, the applicable Congregation(s) will normally be those held in Summer or Winter 2027, subject to eligibility, the student's Congregation selection and the University's final arrangements. Detailed graduation arrangements will be announced by the Programme Office in Semester 2. An exception applies to students who have been approved to undertake an Interdisciplinary Track in their second year of study. In such cases, graduation procedures will normally be placed on hold until the Track has been successfully completed.

Students who wish to make full use of the two-year normative study period are encouraged to plan their studies strategically, allowing room for opportunities such as Study Modules at HKU Global Centres, internships, Interdisciplinary Tracks and other enrichment activities.

4. How can I make use of the two-year normative study period?

The MSc(BA) programme has a two-year normative study period, giving students flexibility to pursue their academic, professional and personal development goals while completing the programme.

Students are encouraged to make full use of the two-year normative study period by, where applicable:

- Completing remaining courses in Year 2;
- Participating in Study Modules at HKU Global Centres;
- Undertaking an Interdisciplinary Track, subject to availability and approval;
- Undertaking internships; and / or
- Participating in enrichment and career development activities.

Students should plan their studies carefully to ensure that all graduation requirements are completed within the permitted study period.

5. What are the Study Modules at Global Centres?

HKU Business School offers Study Modules at its Global Centres in Barcelona, Beijing, Shanghai and Shenzhen. The Study Modules are normally offered in two rounds each academic year, one in Semester 1 and one in Semester 2. The earliest opportunity for Year 1 students to participate is normally Semester 2.

Depending on the offerings of the respective Global Centres, students may enrol in one or two elective courses as general electives of their home programme, and/or, a project-based capstone course (PMSC7902 Business Case Analysis Capstone (Global Centres)), where applicable, during a Study Module, subject to curriculum requirements, quota availability and any applicable approval requirements.

Students who intend to apply for Overseas Academic Degree Certification from the Chinese Service Center for Scholarly Exchange (CSCSE) are advised to observe the relevant CSCSE requirements and shall take no more than three courses offered at Mainland campuses throughout their entire period of study based on the current CSCSE requirements. In addition, students may participate in a Study Module at only one of the four Global Centres during their entire period of study. Participation in multiple Centres or multiple rounds is not permitted.

Detailed arrangements, course offerings and application timelines will be announced by the Study Module Project Team in due course.

6. What is the difference between lecture-based and project-based capstone courses?

Students may have the opportunity to undertake either a lecture-based capstone course or a project-based capstone course.

The project-based capstone enables students to work on real-world business challenges provided by industry partners and apply knowledge acquired throughout the programme in a practical setting.

Project introduction sessions and project bidding for the project-based capstone offered in Hong Kong (PMSC7901 Business Case Analysis Capstone) are expected to commence in around January 2027 for the first round, and around February 2027 for the second round. Detailed arrangements will be communicated separately by the Capstone Project Team.

7. What is an Interdisciplinary Track?

Starting from the 2026-27 academic year, eligible students may apply to pursue an Interdisciplinary Track offered by another specialised Master's programme within HKU Business School. Key features include:

- Participation is entirely optional;
- The Track comprises 30 credits (five 6-credit courses), including 12 credits of core courses and 18 credits of electives;
- The Track is normally undertaken in Year 2;
- Application and approval are required;
- Additional tuition fees apply; and
- Successful completion of the Track will be recorded on the academic transcript issued by the Registry.

Students intending to pursue an Interdisciplinary Track should plan their Year 2 workload carefully. As the Track comprises five courses, students are generally recommended to reserve Year 2 primarily for the Track and leave no more than two home programme courses, preferably electives, to be completed in Year 2.

Further details and application arrangements will be announced in Semester 2.

8. Can I take elective courses offered by other TPg programmes?

Yes. Students may take up to two approved elective courses offered by other TPg programmes within HKU Business School as common electives. Grades obtained in common electives will appear on the academic transcript and be included in the calculation of CGPA.

A list of common electives will be provided by the Programme Office in November/December 2026.

9. Can I take additional elective courses?

Students may apply to take up to two additional electives throughout their entire study period. Please note:

- Additional course fees apply;
- Approval is subject to quota availability and Programme Committee approval;
- Priority will be given to students who require the courses to fulfil their graduation requirements; and
- Grades obtained will be included in the calculation of CGPA.

The completed [application form](#) should normally be submitted to the Programme Office via email at least one month before the start of the relevant module.

10. What are the graduation and Congregation arrangements?

There are two graduation cycles each year:

Congregation	Typical Conferral Period	Eligibility	Collection of Graduation Certificate
Summer Congregation	June (Virtual) July (In-person)	Completion of graduation requirements by the end of Module 5 (around early May)	Normally available for collection after the Congregation; details will be shared on the University website .
Winter Congregation	August (Virtual) November/December (Virtual) November/December (In-person)	Completion of graduation requirements by the end of Module 6	Normally available for collection after the Congregation; details will be shared on the University website .

The above timeline is based on recent years and shall be subject to the University's final arrangements for the relevant year.

Important

Students wishing to attend the Summer Congregation (June/July) are required to complete all graduation requirements by the end of Module 5 (around early May) and indicate their preferred Congregation option by a specified deadline through CES. Further details will be announced by the Programme Office in Semester 2.

Students intending to take the project-based capstone should pay attention to the project timeline, including the project presentation date to be announced, as this may affect eligibility for different Congregations.

11. What happens to my student status and visa after completing my studies?

Upon completion and formal termination of studies, the Student Registration Card will become invalid immediately and you will no longer be able to use the Card to access HKU facilities.

In accordance with the advice of the Registry regarding the expiry date of student visa after graduation, please note that you are eligible to stay in Hong Kong within the period granted by the Hong Kong Immigration Department regardless of the termination date of your studies. This means that you may stay in Hong Kong until the expiry date stated on your landing slip.

Disclaimer: Visa-related information is subject to change from time to time. Students should refer to the latest official information published by the HKSAR Government regarding visa matters and employment arrangements for non-local students in Hong Kong.